

CDN Incident Alert: 0112. TLP: CLEAR**Date****Title BG**

The Kremlin launders disinformation through Pogled.info and Faktibg.com to subvert the Bulgarian media

01/04/2026**Summary**

- Since February 2022, **Pogled.info** has functioned as a primary narrative laundering node in the Bulgarian information space, systematically translating and republishing content from EU-sanctioned outlets RIA Novosti, Sputnik and SCF, in violation of Council Regulation (EU) 2022/350.
- The operation has undergone a significant tactical evolution: whereas early-phase reporting included traceable links to sanctioned entities, a late-2025 shift saw the adoption of a proprietary editorial model. By presenting content as original analysis, the platform now systematically conceals the provenance of its data, representing a deliberate effort to decouple its outputs from sanctioned material and evade attribution
- **Laundered** content enters the local amplification infrastructure through **faktibg.com**, an anonymous disinformation outlet, which republished at least 99 Pogled.info articles in the past month, and its two affiliated Facebook pages: **Истинските новини в България** (14,000 followers) and **Новини от последния час** (50,000 followers).
- **Active** during a high-risk pre-election period (Bulgarian parliamentary elections, 19 April 2026), the operation is a functioning channel for compounding narrative pressure across multiple high-risk narrative clusters, including EU delegitimisation, anti-NATO messaging, and geopolitical conspiratorial framing.

Incident

Pogled.info has operated as a sanctions-evading laundering node since at least February 2022, republishing thousands of articles translated from RIA Novosti, SCF and Sputnik. Its reach is substantial: according to traffic data, it generates 2.2 million visits and 161.3K unique visitors, with 66.95% of traffic coming directly to the site, suggesting a relatively loyal and intentional audience base; this visibility is further reinforced by a significant backlink profile of approximately 187,885 backlinks, which increases the outlet's discoverability and amplifies the spread of its messaging across the wider online ecosystem (based on data from Semrush, an online marketing platform). [Its owner](#), a former Bulgarian Socialist Party faction member who has stood for parliamentary elections, underscores how deeply embedded this infrastructure is within domestic political and business networks. Pogled.info's modus operandi has evolved in two documented phases: in the first phase, articles contained end-of-page hyperlinks directly to the sanctioned outlet, leaving a traceable paper trail; since late 2025, the site has shifted to opaque editorial packaging with no source attribution, rendering the sanctions evasion structurally harder to detect.

The laundered content is distributed through a two-tier local amplification infrastructure. At the first tier, [faktibg.com](#), an anonymous website with no editorial transparency, republishes Pogled.info content at volume (at least 99 articles in the past month). At the second tier, two Facebook pages listing faktibg.com as their official website, [Истинските новини в България](#) (14,500 followers) and [Новини от последния час](#) (50,000 followers), function as automated news aggregators, republishing the full faktibg.com feed and pushing laundered sanctioned content directly to combined audiences of over **64,000** followers.

The full laundering chain: 1. RIA Novosti / Sputnik → 2. Pogled.info (translation, source concealed) → 3. faktibg.com (amplification) → 4. Facebook pages affiliated to faktibg.com (mass distribution).

Between March 20 and 31, 2026, meta-narratives gained significant traction within the active election cycle. These trends align with [high-risk narrative clusters](#) previously identified for the April 2026 Bulgarian elections: specifically, geopolitical conspiratorial frameworks that reinforce the 'collective West as global aggressor' trope, and EU delegitimisation efforts designed to exploit existing international and domestic political fault lines."

Narrative

Meta-narrative 1: The West is a hegemonic power that does not care about anything except fuelling wars.

- Israel and the US deliberately collapsed global markets (**Laundering chain steps: [1](#); [2](#); [3](#); [4](#)**).
- Globalist elites are planning a new world war (**Laundering chain steps: [1](#); [2](#); [3](#); [4](#)**).
- The West is strategically entrapped, Iran controls energy dynamics and Russia holds the decisive geopolitical leverage (**Laundering chain steps: [1](#); [2](#); [3](#); [4](#)**).

Meta-narrative 2: The EU is morally corrupt and hostile to its own citizens.

- Viktor Orbán represents legitimate European sovereignist resistance to Western liberal oppression (**Laundering chain steps: [1](#); [2](#); [3](#); [4](#)**).
- Orbán's triumph as a true antiglobalist in the upcoming April elections will dismantle the EU's dysfunctional architecture, triggering a collapse that dictates Bulgaria's own electoral fate just one week later (**Laundering chain steps: [1](#); [2](#); [3](#); [4](#)**).

Impact

Reach: The amplification chain reaches a combined Facebook audience of over 64,000 followers through the two affiliated pages, with additional exposure via the faktibg.com website.

Outcome: Bulgarian-speaking audiences are exposed to translated Russian state propaganda presented as domestic news, with the origin of the content deliberately concealed. The timing of this monitoring period, immediately preceding the April 2026 elections, heightens the significance of the active narrative clusters. This infrastructure constitutes a functioning channel for rapid cross-pollination of narratives: linking geopolitical conspiratorial messaging to EU legitimacy attacks and domestic political framing, consistent with patterns of coordinated amplification documented in previous Bulgarian election cycles.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective 1: [T0066: Degrade Adversary](#) - Laundered content systematically degrades the West, NATO, the EU, and Ukraine.

Objective 2: [T0079: Divide](#) - Narratives target societal fault lines on EU membership, NATO, Ukraine, and liberal values, amplifying polarisation ahead of elections.

[T0084.003: Deceptively Labeled or Translated](#) - RIA Novosti and Sputnik content translated into Bulgarian and republished as original domestic content.

[T0129.003: Break Association with Content](#) - Since late 2024, Pogled.info removes all source attribution, concealing the sanctioned origin of republished material.

[T0098.002: Leverage Existing Inauthentic News Sites](#) - Pogled.info and faktibg.com serve as the laundering and amplification nodes of the local infrastructure.

[T0049.007: Inauthentic Sites Amplify News and Narratives](#) - The two-tier faktibg.com / Facebook structure drives narrative reach well beyond Pogled.info's direct audience.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Actions taken: Systematic monitoring of the Pogled.info → faktibg.com republication pipeline has been conducted, documenting both the volume of laundered articles and the operational shift toward source concealment.

Recommendations:

- Escalate to Meta requesting geofencing or takedown of the two affiliated Facebook pages for systematic dissemination of content in violation of EU sanctions.
- Flag the network through the DSA mechanism and the Rapid Response System under the Code of Practice on Disinformation, given the pre-election timing.
- Engage the Bulgarian national regulator to assess Pogled.info's compliance with Article 2f(1) of Council Regulation (EU) [2022/350](#) and Article 4g of Council Decision (CFSP) [2022/351](#).

- Submit to BROD (the EDMO hub covering Bulgaria and Romania) for cross-border situational awareness and coordinated fact-checking response.

Report	Threat Actor	Authors	Platforms	FIMI Assessment
N/A	Russia	Svetoslav Malinov; CSD	Web, Facebook	High certainty

Evidence:

<https://archive.ph/PIFnX>
<https://archive.ph/xXEI4>
<https://archive.ph/oLmON>
<https://archive.ph/5DcBL>
<https://archive.ph/I55Lo>
<https://archive.ph/w9QiG>

<https://archive.ph/UVYrq>
<https://archive.ph/UXomF>
<https://archive.ph/viiud>
<https://archive.ph/xlQ2v>
<https://archive.ph/OjoOR>
<https://archive.ph/gLh6e>

<https://archive.ph/aSCGb>
<https://archive.ph/RwGge>
<https://archive.ph/p3dXE>
<https://archive.ph/oHPSB>
<https://archive.ph/FFnEX>
<https://archive.ph/MM4nn>